

Cybersecurity Training Diary

Day 12: Reconnaissance & Footprinting

1. Topics Covered

✓ Intelligence Gathering Techniques

Method	Description	Tools
Passive	No direct interaction	Google Dorks, WHOIS
Active	Direct probing	Nmap, Shodan
Semi-Passive	Indirect interaction	Wappalyzer, BuiltWith

✓ OSINT Framework

```
graph TD
    A[Recon] --> B[Domains]
    A --> C[Emails]
    A --> D[Social Media]
    B --> B1[WHOIS Lookup]
    B --> B2[DNS Dumpster]
    C --> C1[Hunter.io]
    D --> D1[Maltego]
```

✓ Key Information Targets

- **Domain records** (DNS, MX, TXT)
- **Network ranges** (ASN lookup)
- **Employee details** (LinkedIn, company website)

2. Key Takeaways

- ✓ **90% of hacking is reconnaissance** - the more you know, the easier the attack
- ✓ **Passive recon leaves no traces** - legal and stealthy
- ✓ **Shodan** is the "Google for devices" - finds exposed systems

3. Practical Exercises

♦ Exercise 1: Google Dorking

```
site:example.com filetype:pdf
intitle:"index of" password
```

♦ Exercise 2: WHOIS & DNS Lookup

```
whois example.com
dig example.com MX
```

4. Questions for Reflection

- ? How could a company protect against footprinting?
- ? Why is LinkedIn a goldmine for attackers?